

Misandry cannot ensure safety of women of UP

I'm not **the sort of** person who usually responds to the **often** foolish suggestions **floated** by those in authority over us **purportedly** for our good. I prefer to ignore them. But recent **proposals put forward** by the Uttar Pradesh State Women's Commission **are** so silly I feel they deserve greater attention. I fear silence could suggest they're acceptable.

The aim of the proposals is to "improve security for women in public and commercial spaces". That's a **laudable** intention. However, what's proposed is **ludicrous**. Male tailors must no longer take women's measurements. Does this also mean men cannot make women's clothes and only other women can? That appears to follow. Men are also to be prohibited from **attending to** female customers in hairdressing salons. And no man is permitted to train women at gyms or during yoga sessions.

That's not all. Female security staff must be present in all school buses. Men, **presumably**, are unable or unwilling to keep young girls safe or, worse, are actually potential threats to them. And women's clothing stores can only have female staff. Men cannot be trusted to serve women without **endangering** them.

Babita Chauhan, the chairperson of the Uttar Pradesh State Women's Commission, **says** these proposals are not simply meant to enhance women's safety but also to secure and boost women's employment. As she **bluntly** put it, there are two reasons for making these suggestions: "It is from the point of view of women's safety and from the point of view of employment for women." In other words, she proposes to **bar** men from several categories of jobs so as to create opportunities for women to **take** their **place**.

Now, what do you make of this? Does this make sense to you? Are these proposals justified and necessary? Or **unwarranted** and **bewildering**?

You can probably guess how I view them. **For a start**, they reveal an **astonishing** level of **distrust** of men. They **presume** women are not safe in the company of male tailors, hairdressers and shop assistants! You can't rely on men to protect little girls and male instructors are likely to have **ulterior** motives when they **seek** to physically **assist** a woman instructee.

Second, these proposals **intrude** into the privacy of women's lives and restrict their right to choose for themselves. If a woman prefers a male hairstylist — and some of the best are men — or a male couturier — and, again, the top names are male — or a manly gym instructor — if, only, because she's attracted to him — she's no longer able to go to one because it's no longer permitted for her to do so.

Third, this **smacks of** reverse Talibanism. The Afghan version **abhors** women. This time it's men who are to be kept at a distance, their **wicked** minds and **roving hands** to be distrusted and, therefore, disallowed in female company.

Now, tell me, is there a case for suggesting the opposite should also be considered? Should women be barred from serving in shops that only sell men's clothes? Should female gym or yoga instructors be prohibited from instructing male trainees? And what about women who are physiotherapists, dental hygienists, doctors, teachers or work in restaurants? Should they be permitted to serve male patients, customers or clients? After all, if as instructors and shop assistants men cannot be trusted, why are they more **trustworthy** when they meet women as patients or customers?

Are you starting to get my point? If you can't trust men in the roles Ms Chauhan has in mind, should you trust them in others? I'd say that question follows logically. And if you can't trust them at all, what are you saying about men? Pause and think very carefully.

Ms Chauhan, it seems, **is** a **misandrist**. The opposite of a **misogynist**. And, surely, just as much as **misogyny** is a hateful quality, so too is **misandry**? We're familiar with the former but now we're about to learn about the latter. That's one **dubious** reason to be grateful to Babita Chauhan. [\[Practice Exerc.\]](#)

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

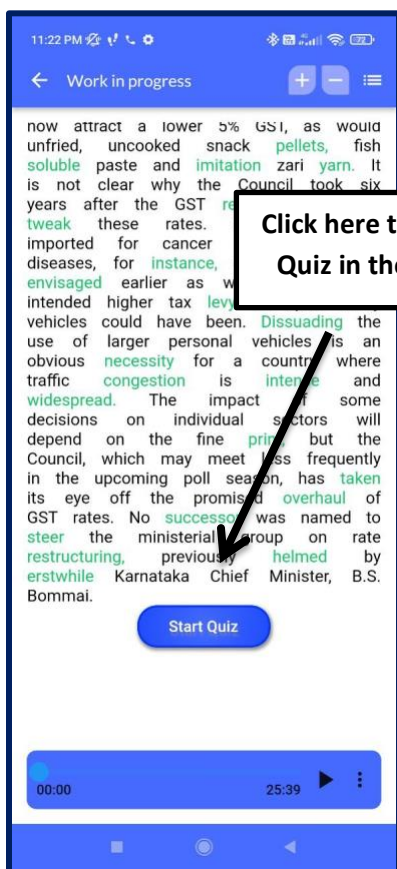
1. **The sort** (of) (noun) – Kind, type, category, class, variety प्रकार
2. **Often** (adverb) – Frequently, regularly, many times, repeatedly अक्सर
3. **Float** (verb) – Propose, suggest, put forward, present, bring up प्रस्ताव रखना
4. **Purportedly** (adverb) – Allegedly, supposedly, ostensibly, apparently कथित रूप से
5. **Put forward** (phrasal verb) – Propose, suggest, present, submit, introduce प्रस्तुत करना
6. **Laudable** (adjective) – Praiseworthy, commendable, admirable, deserving praise सराहनीय
7. **Ludicrous** (adjective) – Absurd, ridiculous, laughable, preposterous, silly हास्यास्पद
8. **Attend to** (verb) – Serve, assist, look after, care for, tend to सेवा करना
9. **Presumably** (adverb) – Probably, likely, apparently, seemingly, one assumes संभवतः
10. **Endanger** (verb) – Put at risk, jeopardize, imperil, threaten, expose to harm खतरे में डालना
11. **Bluntly** (adverb) – Frankly, directly, plainly, straightforwardly, candidly स्पष्ट रूप से
12. **Bar** (verb) – Prohibit, ban, forbid, exclude, prevent रोकना
13. **Take place** (phrase) – Occur, happen, transpire, come about होना
14. **Unwarranted** (adjective) – Unjustified, unnecessary, unreasonable, inappropriate, groundless अनुचित
15. **Bewildering** (adjective) – Confusing, perplexing, baffling, puzzling, mystifying उलझन भरा
16. **For a start** (phrase) – To begin with, firstly, initially, at the outset शुरुआत के लिए
17. **Astonishing** (adjective) – Amazing, surprising, astounding, remarkable, incredible आश्चर्यजनक
18. **Distrust** (noun) – Mistrust, suspicion, doubt, skepticism, lack of trust अविश्वास
19. **Presume** (verb) – Assume, suppose, take for granted, believe, surmise अनुमान करना
20. **Ulterior** (adjective) – Hidden, underlying, concealed, undisclosed, secret गुप्त
21. **Seek** (verb) – Try to obtain, look for, pursue, strive for, search for प्रयास करना

22. **Assist** (verb) – Help, aid, support, lend a hand, facilitate सहायता करना
23. **Intrude** (verb) – Interfere, encroach, infringe, invade, trespass दखल देना
24. **Smack of** (verb) – Resemble, suggest, seem like, have the hint of संकेत देना
25. **Abhor** (verb) – Detest, hate, loathe, despise, feel disgust for घृणा करना
26. **Wicked** (adjective) – Evil, bad, immoral, malevolent, malicious दुष्ट
27. **Roving hands** (noun) – Hands that touch others inappropriately; unwanted physical contact असभ्य स्पर्श
28. **Trustworthy** (adjective) – Reliable, dependable, honest, credible, faithful विश्वसनीय
29. **Misandrist** (noun) – A person who dislikes, despises, or is strongly prejudiced against men पुरुष द्वेषी
30. **Misogynist** (noun) – A person who dislikes, despises, or is strongly prejudiced against women स्त्री द्वेषी
31. **Misogyny** (noun) – Hatred of women, prejudice against women, sexism, anti-women sentiment स्त्री द्वेष
32. **Misandry** (noun) – Hatred of men, prejudice against men, sexism, anti-men sentiment पुरुष द्वेष
33. **Dubious** (adjective) – Doubtful, questionable, suspicious, uncertain, unreliable संदिग्ध

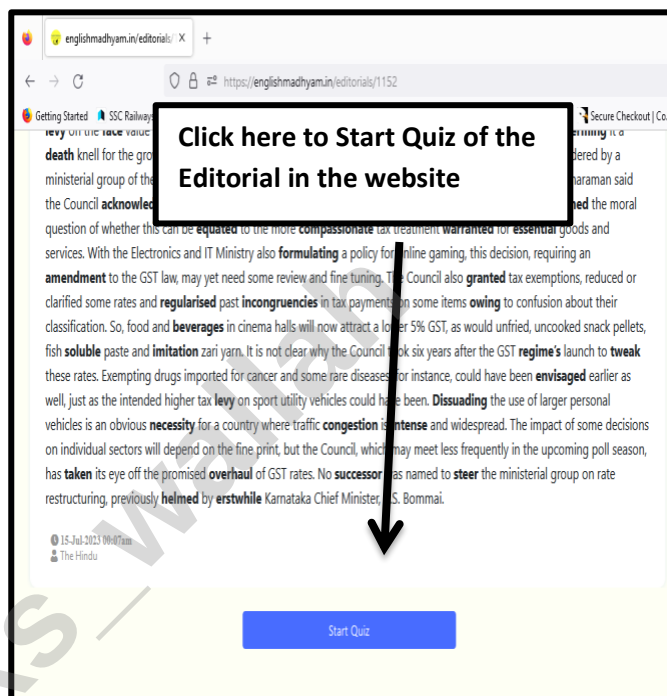
Summary of the Editorial

1. The author criticizes recent proposals by the Uttar Pradesh State Women's Commission, which aim to ensure women's safety in public spaces.
2. The proposals suggest barring male tailors from taking women's measurements and only allowing women to make or sell women's clothing.
3. Male hairdressers and gym or yoga instructors would be prohibited from serving or training female customers.
4. Female security personnel must be present on all school buses, implying men are untrustworthy or pose a threat.
5. These measures also aim to create employment opportunities for women by excluding men from certain jobs.
6. The author argues these proposals reflect deep distrust of men, assuming they are inherently dangerous or predatory.
7. The policies would restrict women's personal freedom, including the right to choose male professionals in areas such as hairstyling and fitness.
8. Many skilled professionals, like top hairdressers and designers, are male, limiting options for women who prefer male experts.
9. The author calls the measures "reverse Talibanism," where men are seen as threats to be kept away from women.
10. The proposals raise questions about gender equality, suggesting a double standard in how trust is assigned based on gender.
11. If men cannot be trusted as shop assistants or instructors, should they also be barred from roles like doctors or teachers, the author asks.
12. The logic behind the proposals is inconsistent, as it unfairly discriminates against men while not addressing broader safety concerns.
13. The editorial highlights the danger of promoting misandry, which the author equates with the hateful nature of misogyny.
14. The author calls out Babita Chauhan, chairperson of the commission, for displaying an extreme bias against men.
15. The article concludes by urging readers to reflect on the proposals' implications and the potential harm of treating men with blanket suspicion.

Practice Exercise: Banking Pattern Based



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